SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #61 · HEAVEN

“I’m not good enough to go to heaven.”

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Where it often comes from

Believing heaven is a reward for good people. Deep awareness of your own sins and failures. Teaching that stressed fear of judgment more than grace. Low self-worth that makes you feel undeserving of anything good. Comparing yourself with people who seem holier.

What Scripture teaches

You are right that you are not good enough to go to heaven. No one is. All have sinned and fall short of the glory of God. But that is exactly why Jesus came. Those who trust Christ are justified freely by His grace. The Father has qualified you to share in the inheritance of the saints. Jesus Himself is preparing a place for you and will welcome you into His presence. Heaven is not earned by being good enough; it is received as a gift.

> *“For all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God, and are justified freely by His grace through the redemption that is in Christ Jesus”* **(Romans 3:23–24)**.

Also see

> “Giving thanks to the Father, who has qualified you to share in the inheritance of the saints in the light” **(Colossians 1:12)**.

> “In My Father’s house are many rooms. If it were not so, would I have told you that I am going there to prepare a place for you? And if I go and prepare a place for you, I will come back and welcome you into My presence, so that you also may be where I am” **(John 14:2–3)**.

> “Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ! By His great mercy He has given us new birth into a living hope through the resurrection of Jesus Christ from the dead, and into an inheritance that is imperishable, undefiled, and unfading, reserved in heaven for you” **(1 Peter 1:3–4)**.

> “For it is by grace you have been saved through faith, and this not from yourselves; it is the gift of God, not by works, so that no one can boast” **(Ephesians 2:8–9)**.

Common self-statements

- Heaven is for good people, not people like me.
- I’ve done too much wrong to go to heaven.
- I’ll never be holy enough.
- God might let others in, but not me.
- I have to become a better person first.
- I don’t deserve heaven.

Common logical errors

- **Misunderstanding the gospel:** Believing heaven is earned by being good enough.
- **Comparison:** Measuring your goodness against others.
- **Labeling:** Calling yourself “not good enough” as if that disqualifies you from grace.

- **Discounting God's promises:** Overlooking that God Himself qualifies those who trust Christ.

Challenging questions

- Is anyone good enough to go to heaven on their own?
- How does Romans 3:24 say people are justified?
- Who qualifies me to share in the inheritance of the saints?
- What is Jesus doing for me right now, according to John 14?
- Am I trusting my goodness or Christ's?
- If heaven is a gift, can I be too unworthy to receive it?
- Have I personally trusted Jesus?

Truth summary

> I am not good enough to go to heaven on my own, and no one is. But Jesus is good enough, and through faith in Him I am justified freely by God's grace. The Father has qualified me, and Jesus is preparing a place for me. Heaven is a gift I receive, not a reward I earn.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Heaven
- Salvation
- Grace
- Eternal Life
- Self-Esteem, Low

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Belief/Salvation
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Forgive/Forgiveness

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> **Overcoming Depression** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'm not good enough to go to heaven"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm not good enough to go to heaven." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Is anyone good enough on their own?
- ☐ How are people justified, according to Romans 3:24?
- ☐ Who qualifies me for the inheritance?
- ☐ What is Jesus preparing for me?
- ☐ Am I trusting my goodness or Christ's?
- ☐ Have I personally trusted Jesus?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ No one is good enough on their own, but Jesus is.
- ☐ I am justified freely by God's grace.
- ☐ The Father has qualified me for the inheritance of the saints.
- ☐ Jesus is preparing a place for me.
- ☐ Heaven is a gift, not a reward.
- ☐ My inheritance is reserved in heaven for me.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **Romans 3:23–24**
  "For all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God, and are justified freely by His grace through the redemption that is in Christ Jesus."
- [ ] **Colossians 1:12**
  "Giving thanks to the Father, who has qualified you to share in the inheritance of the saints in the light."
- [ ] **John 14:2–3**
  "In My Father's house are many rooms. If it were not so, would I have told you that I am going there to prepare a place for you? And if I go and prepare a place for you, I will come back and welcome you into My presence, so that you also may be where I am."
- [ ] **1 Peter 1:3–4**
  "Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ! By His great mercy He has given us new birth into a living hope through the resurrection of Jesus Christ from the dead, and into an inheritance that is imperishable, undefiled, and unfading, reserved in heaven for you."
- [ ] **Ephesians 2:8–9**
  "For it is by grace you have been saved through faith, and this not from yourselves; it is the gift of God, not by works, so that no one can boast."

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Gift of heaven journal:** Each day, write one thing Jesus did to bring me to heaven.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, Colossians 1:12 becomes: "Giving thanks to the Father, who has qualified **Sarah** to share in the inheritance of the saints in the light."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Heaven" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Read Romans 3:21–26,** and underline every phrase that says how we are made right with God.
- ☐ **Pray a simple prayer** trusting Jesus, not your goodness, for heaven.
- ☐ **Read John 14:1–6 each night this week,** and thank Jesus for the place He is preparing.
- ☐ **Talk with a pastor** if you are unsure whether you have trusted Christ.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm not good enough to go to heaven": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One thing Jesus did for me
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm not good enough to go to heaven.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord Jesus, I am not good enough on my own, but You are. Help me reject the lie that I can't go to heaven because I'm not good enough. I trust You, not my goodness. Thank You for justifying me freely by grace and for preparing a place for me. In Your name, Amen.

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